Blynt Workpapers

Improvement Proposal, Competitor Gap Analysis, AI Strategy & Delivery Plan

Benchmarked mainly against Silverfin, plus Caseware, Inflo and DataSnipper

Prepared October 2026 | Draft for discussion
Repository: github.com/ceylonroameryt-bit/blynt-workpaper

1. Executive summary

Blynt already covers the core of a working-paper engagement: trial balance (TB) import, AI-assisted account mapping, area working papers with procedures, review notes, adjustments with segregation of duties, partner sign-off, attachments and an append-only audit log, now persisted to Postgres.

Compared with Silverfin and other leaders, the gaps are not in the review workflow but **before** it (live ledger data) and **after** it (statutory accounts, iXBRL filing, tax), plus client collaboration and evidence automation. One foundation issue - authentication and firm isolation - must be fixed before any real firm uses the product.

Recommendation. Position Blynt as the fastest TB-to-filed-accounts tool for small UK practices (micro and small companies, LLPs, charities). Deliver in four phases over roughly 9-12 months: (1) secure foundation, (2) the reasons firms switch - Xero sync, client portal, accounts production, (3) iXBRL filing plus AI insight, (4) depth - more integrations, evidence matching, tax, custom templates. Use AI in 12 specific places (section 6), always as a suggestion a human confirms.

Top 5 actions

- **Fix sign-in and access control** - API currently trusts role/user headers from the browser.
- **Make the dashboard live** - replace hardcoded actions, deadlines and activity with real data.
- **Ship Xero live sync** - the main reason firms choose Silverfin.
- **Add a client portal** - document requests tied to working papers, with reminders.
- **Produce statutory accounts and iXBRL** from the signed-off TB - lets firms drop a second tool.

2. Where Blynt is today

Assessment based on the current code on master (commit fcb3a4a).

Area	Status today	Rating
TB import	CSV import engine with validation and balance checks	Good
Account mapping	Rules + AI suggestions with confidence and alternatives; manager confirms	Good
Working papers	Templates and procedures for every area; roll forward from prior year	Good
Review and sign-off	Review notes with replies, prepared / reviewed / partner sign-off, lock blockers	Good
Adjustments	AJE workflow; preparer cannot approve own journal	Good
Audit trail	Append-only audit log of actions	Good
Attachments	Real file uploads stored in Postgres	Fair
Persistence	Whole workspace saved as one JSONB row (Neon Postgres)	Fair - will not scale
Ledger integrations	Xero / QuickBooks / Sage / FreeAgent shown as sources, but only CSV works	Gap
Accounts / filing / tax	None - stops at sign-off	Gap
Client collaboration	None - "chase client" is text only	Gap
Dashboard	Mostly hardcoded sample figures	Gap
AI assistant	"Ask" box returns a fixed answer	Gap
Security	Role and user taken from request headers; single shared workspace for all firms	Critical

3. Competitor landscape

Most public material on Silverfin is its own marketing; G2 and Software Advice list no user reviews. The table reflects what each vendor says it offers.

Vendor	Strengths	What it means for Blynt
Silverfin (main benchmark)	Live Xero sync that updates numbers and flags changes; standardised working papers; accounts production, corporation tax and company secretarial modules; direct Companies House filing with iXBRL; white-labelled client portal; queries and alerts across the whole client base; AI assistant and AI mapping.	Breadth is the moat. Blynt must match the ledger-to-filing journey for small entities and win on speed, simplicity and price.
Caseware (Cloud, AiDA)	Market standard for mid-to-large audit; 85+ cloud apps; AiDA guidance and document summaries; bought Extractly.ai (2025) for document extraction.	Do not compete on audit depth. Borrow document extraction and in-context AI guidance.
Inflo	Audit data analytics, e-workpapers, client collaboration, engagement management, API for repeatable tests.	Add analytics (variance, ratios, journal testing) and strong client requests.
DataSnipper	Excel-based evidence matching, OCR, automatic cross-referencing; UpLink for client requests.	Evidence matching inside the working paper is a clear, sellable AI feature.

4. Gap analysis vs Silverfin

Capability	Silverfin	Blynt today	Gap
Live ledger sync (Xero etc.)	Yes, auto-refresh + change alerts	CSV upload only	High
Working papers + review	Yes	Yes	None
AI account mapping	Yes	Yes	None
Accounts production	Yes	No	High
iXBRL / Companies House filing	Yes	No	High
Corporation tax (CT600)	Yes	No	Medium
Company secretarial	Yes	No	Low
Client portal / requests	Yes, white-labelled	No	High
Cross-client alerts	Yes	No (hardcoded dashboard)	Medium
AI assistant on real data	Yes	Fixed reply	Medium
Evidence matching / OCR	Limited (DataSnipper leads)	Extract route exists, not wired in	Opportunity
Analytics (variance, ratios)	Partial	No	Medium
Secure multi-firm access	Yes	No	Critical

5. Proposals in detail

Effort: S about 1 week, M 2-4 weeks, L more than a month, for one experienced developer. Estimates are rough and should be refined during planning.

#	Proposal	Priority	Effort
P0	Real sign-in, firm isolation and server-side roles	Must do first	M
P1	Normalised database schema	High	M
P2	Live dashboard	High (quick win)	S
P3	Exports and review packs	Medium	S
P4	Xero live sync	High	M
P5	Client portal and document requests	High	M
P6	Statutory accounts production	High	L
P7	iXBRL and Companies House filing	High	L
P8	Firm-wide alerts and monitoring	Medium	S-M
P9	Analytics	Medium	S-M
P10	AI assistant on real workspace data	Medium	M
P11	Evidence matching	Medium	M
P12	QuickBooks, Sage and FreeAgent sync	Medium	M each
P13	Journal entry testing	Later	M
P14	Corporation tax (CT600)	Later	L
P15	Template editor	Later	M

P0. Real sign-in, firm isolation and server-side roles

What	Replace header-based identity with proper authentication (e.g. Neon Auth / Better Auth), MFA for partners, firm_id enforced on every query, role checks on the server for sign-off, approval and lock.
Why	Today any browser can claim to be a partner and sign off work; all firms share one workspace row.
AI use	None directly; AI later uses the same permission checks.
Priority / effort	Must do first / M

P1. Normalised database schema

What	Move from one JSONB workspace row to proper tables (clients, engagements, tb_lines, mappings, workpapers...). Row-level locking instead of whole-workspace version conflicts.
Why	One row will conflict as soon as two people work at once and grows with every client.
AI use	Enables reliable cross-client queries for AI alerts and search.
Priority / effort	High / M

P2. Live dashboard

What	Next actions, deadlines (from year ends and filing rules) and activity feed built from real data.
Why	First screen currently shows sample figures - undermines trust in demos.
AI use	AI ranks the next actions by risk and deadline.
Priority / effort	High (quick win) / S

P3. Exports and review packs

What	Engagement file as PDF and Excel; reviewer pack with open notes and sign-offs.
Why	Standard in Caseware and Silverfin; needed for regulators and file reviews.
AI use	AI writes a one-page engagement summary for the pack.
Priority / effort	Medium / S

P4. Xero live sync

What	OAuth connect, scheduled TB and ledger pull, "changed since reviewed" flags on working papers.
Why	Silverfin's main strength and the top reason firms pick it.
AI use	AI explains what changed and which papers it affects.
Priority / effort	High / M

P5. Client portal and document requests

What	Request lists per working paper, secure client upload, auto-link to the paper, scheduled reminders, branded portal.
Why	Silverfin portal, Inflo and DataSnipper UpLink all offer this.
AI use	AI drafts the request list from open procedures and drafts chaser emails.
Priority / effort	High / M

P6. Statutory accounts production

What	Generate FRS 105 and FRS 102 1A accounts (then LLP and charity) from the signed-off TB, with notes and directors report.
Why	Lets firms cancel their separate accounts tool; Silverfin links WPs to accounts.
AI use	AI drafts accounting policies, notes and directors report text for review.
Priority / effort	High / L

P7. iXBRL and Companies House filing

What	iXBRL tagging of accounts and direct filing with status tracking.
Why	Silverfin files directly; without it firms will not switch.
AI use	AI suggests taxonomy tags for unusual lines; human confirms.
Priority / effort	High / L

P8. Firm-wide alerts and monitoring

What	Rules across all clients: overdrawn directors loan (s455), unmapped balances over materiality, margin swings, missing evidence, overdue filings.
Why	Matches Silverfin's cross-client queries and alerts.
AI use	AI anomaly detection proposes new alerts from patterns.
Priority / effort	Medium / S-M

P9. Analytics

What	Prior-year variance with required explanations over a threshold, ratio analysis, materiality calculator.
Why	Inflo's main selling point.
AI use	AI drafts variance explanations from ledger detail.
Priority / effort	Medium / S-M

P10. AI assistant on real workspace data

What	Ask questions in plain English ("which clients have unmapped balances over 10k?") answered from live data, with links to the source.
Why	Silverfin Assistant and Caseware AiDA.
AI use	Core AI feature - see section 6.
Priority / effort	Medium / M

P11. Evidence matching

What	Read uploaded invoices and bank statements, match amounts/dates/payees to schedule lines, tick automatically.
Why	DataSnipper's core feature; Caseware bought Extractly.ai for this.
AI use	AI document extraction plus matching; existing /ai/extract route is the start.
Priority / effort	Medium / M

P12. QuickBooks, Sage and FreeAgent sync

What	Same flow as Xero for the other sources already shown in the app.
Why	Matches Silverfin integration range.
AI use	AI mapping learns each provider chart of accounts.
Priority / effort	Medium / M each

P13. Journal entry testing

What	Pull ledger journals; flag weekend, round-sum, unusual-user and late entries.
Why	Inflo and Caseware offer it.
AI use	AI risk scoring of journals.
Priority / effort	Later / M

P14. Corporation tax (CT600)

What	Tax computation from accounts, capital allowances, HMRC filing.
Why	Silverfin's corporation tax module.
AI use	AI flags disallowable expenses and allowance claims.
Priority / effort	Later / L

P15. Template editor

What	Firms build and version their own working-paper templates and procedures.
Why	Silverfin and Caseware templates.
AI use	AI generates a template draft from a description or an old Excel paper.
Priority / effort	Later / M

6. AI strategy - using AI everywhere it helps

Principle: AI prepares, a qualified person decides. Every AI output is a suggestion with its source, a confidence level and a logged human confirmation, which fits audit and assurance standards.

#	Where AI is used	What it does	Human control
1	Account mapping (exists)	Maps client accounts to the Blynt chart with confidence and alternatives	Manager confirms
2	Change explanations	Explains what changed after a ledger sync and which papers are affected	Preparer reviews
3	Document extraction	Reads invoices, bank statements, loan agreements into structured data	Shown beside source
4	Evidence matching	Matches extracted evidence to schedule lines and proposes tick marks	Preparer accepts each tick
5	Variance explanations	Drafts reasons for movements against prior year from ledger detail	Preparer edits
6	Anomaly detection	Flags unusual balances, journals and margins across clients	Alerts, not changes
7	Conclusion drafting (exists)	Drafts working-paper conclusions from procedures done	Reviewer signs off
8	Review assistant	Pre-reviews papers for missing evidence or unsupported conclusions	Reviewer decides
9	Client requests	Builds request lists and polite chaser emails	Sent only after approval
10	Accounts text	Drafts policies, notes and directors report	Partner approves
11	Filing tags and tax	Suggests iXBRL tags and tax adjustments	Human confirms
12	Workspace assistant	Answers plain-English questions over firm data with links	Read-only by default

How to build it well

- **Model choice:** a strong model (e.g. Claude Opus 5.5) for drafting and review; a fast, cheap model (e.g. Claude Haiku 5.5) for mapping and extraction at volume.
- **Grounding:** pass only the engagement data the user may see; cite the account, document or line used.
- **Logging:** store every AI suggestion, model, prompt version and the human decision (the app already has an ai_lineage table).
- **Privacy:** no client data used for training; UK/EU data residency options; redact personal data in prompts where possible.
- **Quality:** a test set of real (anonymised) TBs and papers to measure mapping accuracy and drafting quality before each release.
- **Cost:** cache firm-level context, batch overnight work (anomaly scans), cap per-firm usage.

7. Delivery plan

Phase	Timing (indicative)	Scope	Outcome
1. Foundation	Months 1-2	P0 sign-in and roles, P1 schema, P2 live dashboard, P3 exports	Safe for a pilot firm
2. Reasons to switch	Months 3-5	P4 Xero sync, P5 client portal, P6 accounts production (FRS 105 / 102 1A)	Pilot firms run real year ends
3. Complete the journey	Months 6-8	P7 iXBRL filing, P8 alerts, P9 analytics, P10 AI assistant	TB to filed accounts in one tool
4. Depth	Months 9-12	P11 evidence matching, P12 more integrations, P13 journal testing, P14 CT600, P15 template editor	Feature parity for small practices

Phase 1 checklist

- Authentication with MFA; remove trust in x-user-role / x-user-id headers.
- Firm isolation on every read and write; tests that one firm cannot see another.
- Server-side role checks for sign-off, approval, lock and reset.
- Normalised tables and a migration from the JSONB row.
- Dashboard driven by real data; remove sample figures.
- PDF/Excel engagement export.
- Error monitoring, backups and a restore test.

Success measures

Measure	Target
Time from TB import to all accounts mapped	Under 10 minutes for a small company
AI mapping accepted without change	Over 85%
Engagement time saved vs firm baseline	30% or more
Pilot firms live	3 by end of phase 2
Accounts filed through Blynt	First filings by end of phase 3
Security incidents	Zero; external penetration test before launch

8. Positioning and pricing

- **Who:** small UK practices (1-30 staff) doing micro, small, LLP and charity work.
- **Promise:** trial balance to filed accounts in one simple tool, set up in a day.
- **Against Silverfin:** broad and enterprise-oriented (owned by Moneybird since 2024); win on speed, clarity and price.
- **Pricing idea:** transparent per-client or per-seat pricing published on the website, with a free pilot for the first engagements.

9. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
iXBRL and filing are complex and regulated	Start with FRS 105 and 102 1A; use a recognised tagging approach; test filings early
Ledger APIs change or rate-limit	Build a provider layer; Xero first; monitor sync health
AI errors in professional work	Suggestion-only design, citations, confidence, logged human decisions
Client data security	Phase 1 security work, encryption, access reviews, penetration test
Scope creep across too many modules	Strict phase gates; pilot firm feedback before each phase
Single JSONB row limits growth	P1 schema migration in phase 1

10. Sources

Public sources reviewed in October 2026. Vendor pages are marketing material and not independently verified.

- silverfin.com/en-gb/resources/caseware-vs-silverfin-best-value
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